

New Homeowner Maintenance Guide — Action Checklist

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SCHEDULE SEASONAL INSPECTIONS

- ☐ **Schedule professional HVAC tune-ups in spring and fall to catch system failures before they happen and extend equipment lifespan.:** Schedule professional HVAC tune-ups in spring and fall to catch system failures before they happen and extend equipment lifespan.
- ☐ **Inspect your roof in spring using binoculars or by walking the perimeter to spot missing shingles or sagging areas before rainy season arrives.:** Inspect your roof in spring using binoculars or by walking the perimeter to spot missing shingles or sagging areas before rainy season arrives.
- ☐ **Clean dryer vent lines annually by pulling out the dryer, disconnecting the vent, and removing all lint buildup to prevent house fires.:** Clean dryer vent lines annually by pulling out the dryer, disconnecting the vent, and removing all lint buildup to prevent house fires.
- ☐ **Inspect exterior trim and siding in summer when dry weather allows you to paint or patch any rot, peeling paint, or pest entry points.:** Inspect exterior trim and siding in summer when dry weather allows you to paint or patch any rot, peeling paint, or pest entry points.

PRIORITIZE LIFE-SAFETY TASKS

- ☐ **Schedule a furnace inspection before heating season to check the heat exchanger for carbon monoxide risks and verify safety controls are functioning.:** Schedule a furnace inspection before heating season to check the heat exchanger for carbon monoxide risks and verify safety controls are functioning.
- ☐ **Book a sewer scope if your home is over 20 years old to catch tree roots and pipe degradation before they cause a backup costing thousands.:** Book a sewer scope if your home is over 20 years old to catch tree roots and pipe degradation before they cause a backup costing thousands.

- ☐ **Test smoke and CO detectors by pressing the test button on every unit, replacing batteries and any detectors over 10 years old—this takes 10 minutes and saves lives.:** Test smoke and CO detectors by pressing the test button on every unit, replacing batteries and any detectors over 10 years old—this takes 10 minutes and saves lives.
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- ☐ **Disaster-proof your home by disconnecting outdoor hoses, closing faucet shut-offs, and blowing out irrigation lines before freezing temperatures arrive.:** Disaster-proof your home by disconnecting outdoor hoses, closing faucet shut-offs, and blowing out irrigation lines before freezing temperatures arrive.
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PERFORM PREVENTATIVE MAINTENANCE

- ☐ **Clean gutters twice yearly in spring and fall to prevent roof leaks, foundation damage, and basement flooding in that order.:** Clean gutters twice yearly in spring and fall to prevent roof leaks, foundation damage, and basement flooding in that order.
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- ☐ **Apply fresh caulk and weatherstripping around windows, doors, and utility penetrations each fall to eliminate drafts and maximize energy efficiency.:** Apply fresh caulk and weatherstripping around windows, doors, and utility penetrations each fall to eliminate drafts and maximize energy efficiency.
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- ☐ **Lubricate garage door springs, cables, and rollers with silicone spray to prevent failure and ensure smooth operation year-round.:** Lubricate garage door springs, cables, and rollers with silicone spray to prevent failure and ensure smooth operation year-round.
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- ☐ **Run each irrigation zone in summer to identify broken heads, underground leaks, and overspray onto the house before you get a shocking water bill.:** Run each irrigation zone in summer to identify broken heads, underground leaks, and overspray onto the house before you get a shocking water bill.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.